It should be noted that the reports coming in about this possible date were received from many sources.

From a military perspective, going to war on this date would have been a strain. There were still not enough offensive weapons. Syria was going to begin receiving them only at the end of 1972, and some would arrive only in the first quarter of 1973. Syria requested to postpone the date to April 1973. (The following items had still not been supplied in full: MiG-21s; Sukhoi-20s; SA-6, ZSU-23, SA-3, and improved SA-7 missiles and antiaircraft systems; a Luna artillery rocket system; antiaircraft missiles; and Mirage and Lightning aircraft.) There were no reports of detailed operational planning or preparation on the ground for this date, as there were for the dates that followed.

Time B: Late April to early June 1973

Among the reasons for these possible dates were:

1. Hafez Ismail's visit to the United States had failed, and therefore one could not expect any "miracles" from the July summit meeting unless military action was launched.
2. Sadat would not be able to hold on to power if he did not carry out military action. Defeat would be preferable to the current stalemate.
3. It would put pressure on the superpowers ahead of the summit and might influence the Security Council's discussions.
4. The military preparations were completed.

In contrast to the earlier warning, this time our sources reported concrete plans for the attack and—to some degree of detail— indications of evidence on the ground. For example, reports came in that some units were being brought closer to the front lines and that transport battalions were being mobilized, that a brigade was being advanced, and that a Mirage squadron had arrived in Egypt from Libya. There was also a report about a plan to launch the war with artillery shelling along the length of the Canal, deep attacks on Israel's heartland (on Israeli ports), and the construction of ten bridges on the Canal. It was also reported that a detailed Syrian operational plan had been completed.